

July

12

1770

Spinning jenny

James Hargreaves of Lancashire, UK, patented the spinning jenny, a machine that turns raw cotton fibre into thread for weaving. The invention helped trigger Britain's Industrial Revolution.



Born this day

1997 Malala Yousafzai,

Pakistani activist. She survived an assassination attempt after campaigning for girls' rights to education. She is the youngest recipient of the Nobel Peace Prize.

Also on this day

1576 The Mughal Empire seized control of Bengal in the Indian subcontinent after defeating Sultan Daud Khan Karrani at the Battle of Rajmahal.

1776 British explorer James Cook set sail on an attempt to find the Northwest Passage – a sea route through the Arctic Ocean. He was killed while visiting Hawaii.

1863 The British colonial army invaded Indigenous Māori land at Waikato, New Zealand.

1971 The tricoloured Australian Aboriginal Flag was flown for the first time in Adelaide, Australia, on National Aborigines Day.

1493

Nuremberg Chronicle

The *Nuremberg Chronicle* by German historian Hartmann Schedel was

published. One of the most richly illustrated books of the 15th century, it chronicled the history of the Christian world.

